

Niche, voice, and bio craft

Week 1, Lecture 2 · Grow on X: From Zero to 10,000 Followers

Autumn 2026

What we will cover

- Why narrow niches grow faster than broad ones
- The who/what/how triangle for diagnosing your positioning
- Bio as a conversion landing page: four elements that convert
- Profile photo and header as silent signals

Part 1: the niche

Niche is a positioning decision, not a topic

- “Personal finance” = a topic. Anyone can claim it.
- “Debt payoff strategies for nurses in their first five years” = a niche
- The reader immediately knows: is this for me?
- Narrow niches convert profile visits to follows at a higher rate

Why narrow wins early

- Graham (2013): Facebook launched Harvard-only. Intensity within a small group produces word-of-mouth.
- A creator unmistakably useful to one person grows faster among that person's peers
- Being vaguely interesting to everyone = being precisely relevant to no one
- You can broaden later. You cannot build momentum without a core.

The Personal Monopoly

- Perell (2019): the intersection of your skills, interests, and perspective that no one else occupies the same way
- Not about being the only expert. About being the only *you* serving *this* reader.
- Niche clarity comes from action, not contemplation: you find your niche by writing, not by planning

Finding the niche: Welsh's three steps

1. Find a market where people already spend money on the problem
2. Immerse in the conversations: forums, comment sections, X replies
3. Find where your skills intersect with that demand

The intersection is your niche. "The best ideas don't come from brainstorming in isolation."
(Welsh, 2024)

Part 2: voice

The who/what/how triangle

Three corners. All three must be clear.

- **Who you serve:** a specific person with a specific problem
- **What you say:** the claims and frameworks you consistently bring
- **How you sound:** tone, rhythm, humor, how you handle disagreement

Most accounts have one strong corner and two weak ones.

Diagnosing the weak corner

Weak “who”

Weak “how”

- Clear opinions, no specific reader
 - Content talks to everyone
 - Connects with no one
 - Fix: write for one person, not a demographic
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- Clear who and what
 - Voice is generic
 - Interchangeable with a dozen accounts in the niche
 - Fix: find the one stylistic choice that is unmistakably you

Part 3: bio craft

The bio is the decision page

- A profile visitor has already expressed interest: they clicked
- You have roughly three seconds and 160 characters
- Most bios treat this as a resume. Resumes describe the past.
- A converting bio makes a promise about the future.

Four elements that convert

1. **Name/identity:** who you help and what you help them do (not your job title)
2. **Headline:** the specific outcome or transformation you deliver
3. **Proof:** one piece of evidence the headline is credible
4. **CTA:** one next step (newsletter, pinned thread, free resource)

Missing any one element leaks follows you already earned.

A bio rewrite, live

Before:

Software engineer at a startup. I write about tech, productivity, and life. Occasional runner. Views are my own.

After:

I help new engineers survive (and enjoy) their first startup year.
3 years at Series A–C companies. Writing what I wish I’d known.
Free weekly guide: [\[link\]](#)

Identity. Headline. Proof. CTA.

Profile photo and header

- Photo: face clearly visible, high contrast. People follow people.
- Header: one clear signal. A single line of text, a visual that implies your topic, or social proof.
- Header should reinforce the bio, not contradict or ignore it.
- Both are visible before the visitor reads a word.

Write on the Internet and become known for something unique, and serendipity will come next.

<footer>David Perell, "The Ultimate Guide to Writing Online," 2019</footer>

Take-aways

1. A niche is a positioning decision. Narrow beats broad for early growth because it produces the word-of-mouth that broad never does.
2. The who/what/how triangle diagnoses positioning gaps. Find the weakest corner and fix it first.
3. A bio that converts has four elements: identity, headline, proof, CTA. Treat it as a landing page, not a resume.
4. Photo and header signal before the visitor reads. Make them consistent with the bio.

What's next

- **Reading:** Week 1 reading covers funnel, niche, and bio together
- **Section (this week):** Audit five accounts in your niche. Bring a bio draft.
- **HW 1 (out this week):** Niche statement and bio rewrite. Due next week.
- **Week 2:** Content formats and the posting calendar